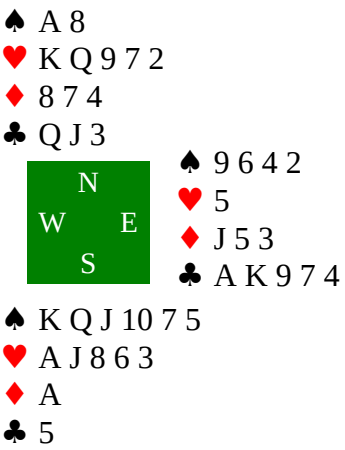
***Board 1***
South Deals
None Vul




| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♠ |
| Pass | 2♥ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♠[2] | Pass | 6♥ |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♥ by North
Lead: ♣K

Since there has not been a clear agreement on the trump suit you can assume it is ♥s, the last bid suit.

So you have two Key-Cards (♠A and ♥K, along with the ♥Q). You therefore bid 5♠ and partner bids 6♥.

***Board 2***
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q J 5
♥ A Q J 3
♦ Q 6
♣ K Q J

♠ 8
♥ 10 7 4
♦ A K J 9
♣ 9 8 6 5 2

♠ 6 4
♥ 8 6 2
♦ 10 7 4 3 2
♣ 10 4 3

♠ A 10 9 7 3 2
♥ K 9 5
♦ 8 5
♣ A 7

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1♣ | Pass | 1♠ |
| Pass | 4♠ | Pass | 5♣ |
| Pass | 5♥ | Pass | 5♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

5♠ by South
Lead: ♦K

Partner's jump to 4♠ indicates he is prepared to play at game even if you have as few as 6 points. So he must have 20 points or so. With your 14 that puts you in slam range.

Despite your conviction that this hand is going to slam you should **NOT** ask for Key-Cards holding a worthless doubleton. Instead, you make a slam try by bidding your cheapest control, 5♣. Partner says 5♥. What is your next bid?

You can only say 5♠. Partner would have control-bid ♦s if he held the Ace since controls are bid up-the-line. His failure to show it means he doesn't have it. Since you might be off the first two ♦ tricks you stop at 5♠.

Yes, partner should probably have opened 2NT. Sometimes partners don't make the bids you think they oughta.

***Board 3***
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 9 6 2
♥ K 8 6 5
♦ 5
♣ K Q 3

♠ A 4
♥ Q J 9 4
♦ J 10 8 2
♣ 10 7 4

♠ 5 3
♥ 10 3 2
♦ Q 9 7 4
♣ J 9 6 5

♠ J 10 8 7
♥ A 7
♦ A K 6 3
♣ A 8 2

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♦ |
| Pass | 1♠ | Pass | 3♠ |
| Pass | 4NT[1] | Pass | 5♦[2] |
| Pass | 6♠ | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 0 or 3 key cards

6♠ by North
Lead: ♥2

You have 3 Key-Cards so you bid 5♦. Partner bids 6♠.

***Board 4***
South Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ K Q 8 4<br>♥ A J 6<br>♦ J 3<br>♣ Q J 8 3 | |
| ♠ 10 6<br>♥ 7 4 3<br>♦ 10 9 8 7 4<br>♣ 7 5 4 | | ♠ 5 3<br>♥ 10 9 8 2<br>♦ A Q 6 2<br>♣ 10 9 2 |
| | ♠ A J 9 7 2<br>♥ K Q 5<br>♦ K 5<br>♣ A K 6 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1♠ |
| Pass | 2NT | Pass | 3NT |
| Pass | 4♥ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♠[2] | Pass | 6♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Roman Key Card Blackwood
2. 2 key cards with the trump queen

6♠ by South
Lead: ♣4

Your partnership plays Jacoby 2NT convention, so partner's 2NT shows a game-forcing raise in ♠s. Your 3NT bid indicates a 5-card suit and "extra values". Partner's 4♥ is a control-bid showing the ♥A.

What you need to know now about partner's hand is Key-Cards so you bid 4NT. He answers 5♠. What is your bid?

Partner's response says 2 Key-Cards and the ♠Q. So you are missing either the trump King or the ♦A. So you shouldn't bid 7, but you will almost surely make 6. You bid 6♠.